



PSE's 2050 Energy Plan

A Citizen Response

Puget Sound Energy recently released preliminary modeling for its **2027 Integrated System Plan**, describing how the company will power our region through 2050. PSE's plan relies heavily on gas and an unproven nuclear reactor. Instead of curbing emissions, PSE would incur billions of dollars in pollution fees and pass the cost onto customers, significantly raising gas and electric bills.

There is a better way. Using PSE's own numbers, a citizen organization proposes an alternative plan based on solutions already working across the country. Less cost, less risk, and lower emissions – a better future for all.

	PSE's 2050 Plan	Our Proposal
Electric grid	Nearly half of new power sources are gas plants and an unproven nuclear reactor.	Build on proven technologies like wind, batteries, geothermal, and resources customers already own.
Gas system	Number of gas customers remain relatively stagnant through 2050.	Number of customers shrinks dramatically. PSE provides incentives to move customers to cleaner, cheaper heating and appliances.
Cost (2027-2050)	≈ \$125 billion (includes pollution allowances)	≈ \$100 billion (includes financial assistance for gas customers to switch)
Risks	The electric grid would rely heavily on gas generation. For gas customers, risk of chaotic “death spiral” leaving the most vulnerable to pay for the system.	Minimizes risk to the grid through diversified energy resources. Orderly, equitable transition for customers to get off gas.
Pollution & emissions	Offsets emissions by buying carbon allowances — a cost that grows to dominate monthly gas bills.	Emissions decline to near zero by 2050 in accordance with Washington clean energy laws.
Customer bills	PSE projects gas rates will be 5x higher by 2050. Electric rates will rise 2.5x and are exposed to gas prices.	Bills rise more slowly because electricity is both cheaper and more efficient than gas. No pollution charges added on.

Sources: PSE 2027 Integrated System Plan (RPAG presentation, May 28, 2026), slides 30, 31, 49–52.

PSE's plan is still a draft. We ask the Washington Utilities and Transportation Commission to require an independent review of PSE's plan to facilitate a better outcome for customers, the climate, and the regional economy. We deserve a fair evaluation of a better plan.